banks was 46.6 per cent in deposits and 44.5 per cent in credit. Their combined share in credit was 65.8 per cent.

In 2017–18, the combined share of SBI Group and nationalized banks was reported at 63.2 per cent in the banking returns statistics published by RBI. This was 2.6 per cent less than the combined share of 65.8 per cent in 2016–17. In 2016–17, while SBI Group had lost only 0.1 per cent share in credit compared to the previous year, the remaining PSBs (the erstwhile nationalized bank group) lost 2.2 per cent.

While RBI data does not provide a separate share of SBI Group and the remaining nationalized banks, the annual report of SBI (now a single entity as all associate banks have been merged in SBI) states that SBI's share of advances in the country was 19.7 per cent in 2019–20. As the combined share of PSBs in outstanding credit was 57.7 per cent in 2019–20, the share of the rest of the PSBs works out to 38 per cent. Juxtaposing against the share in credit in 2013–14, SBI Group has lost only 2.4 per cent market share of credit (19.7 per cent vis-a-vis 22.1 per cent), whereas the rest of the PSBs (essentially twenty nationalized banks now consolidated into twelve) had lost as much as 13.1 per cent market share in outstanding credit.

SBI and the rest of the nationalized banks had a different origin, evolution and banking culture. SBI was effectively always a state-controlled bank but with a private-sector banking culture, which did not change much after it was nominally nationalized in 1955. The other twenty nationalized banks were promoted by princes, private individuals and industrial houses. They worked as private banks and went through the shock of government ownership and control in 1969 (fourteen banks) and 1980 (six banks). Their culture and management changed completely and they became pretty much carbon copies of each other and very close to government departments over the years.

Thus, it is advisable to treat SBI and the other PSBs separately.